

The 720: TSMC 3Q preview, Kotak Mahindra Bank, HDFC Bank, AmorePacific, India Consumer, SpaceX, US Semis

In Focus | TSMC 3Q preview

TSMC – Strong AI Demand Drives CapEx and Estimate Upgrades – Buy. We reiterate our Buy rating and raise our 12m TP to NT\$3,300 (ADR to US\$660 from US\$620), expecting strong growth momentum into 2027 on broadening demand across AI accelerators, networking, and server CPUs driven by agentic AI. We increase our 2026E/2027E/2028E EPS estimates by 1%/7%/8%, reflecting higher utilization rates for N2 and N3 nodes alongside milder gross margin dilution from the ongoing N2 ramp. Furthermore, we raise our 2027E and 2028E CapEx forecasts to US\$85bn and US\$98bn, respectively, as we expect the company to scale its leading-edge investments to support sustained long-term customer infrastructure needs. *Evelyn Yu*

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India Banks | Kotak, HDFC Bank, Axis Bank

Kotak Mahindra Bank – Big loan growth surprise – Buy (on CL). We raise our FY27-FY29E earnings estimates by 4-8% and our 12m TP to Rs540 following a much stronger-than-expected F2Q27 business update. Organic loan growth accelerated sharply to 19% YoY, driven by a revival in high-margin unsecured retail lending, while total deposit growth reached 23% YoY, bolstered by outsized US\$5.8bn inflows from FCNR deposits. We believe this strong liquidity positioning at the bottom of the interest rate cycle, coupled with robust 14% YoY CASA growth and higher-than-expected RBI rate hikes, provides significant tailwinds for the bank. Consequently, we now forecast an 18% core PPOP CAGR over FY26-FY29E and expect the stock to compound and re-rate as earnings inflect. *Sumeet Kariwala*

HDFC Bank – Normalized growth largely stable on YoY basis – Buy. 2QFY27 provisional figures showed strong headline deposit growth of 19% YoY, though normalized deposit growth remained steady at 15% YoY when adjusted for FCNR-B flows. Headline gross advances grew 16% YoY, but excluding overseas branch facilities, growth was slightly lower at 14% YoY. Heading into earnings, we expect investor focus to center on the margin trajectory, the fee income outlook regarding

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proposed insurance regulations, and retail lending momentum. We believe the bank is positioned for a strong inflection in pre-provision operating profit growth starting in FY27, driven by bottoming margins and robust operating leverage. 12m TP of Rs861. *Sumeet Kariwala*

Axis Bank – Strong FCNR Flows Repay High-Cost Deposits – Buy. Axis Bank reported solid 2QFY27 provisional figures, highlighted by US\$10.6bn in FCNR-B deposit mobilization and headline gross advances growth of 23% YoY. The bank utilized roughly 55% of these FCNR-B flows to repay high-cost bulk deposits, which we expect will limit the drag from excess liquidity and support better domestic net interest margin (NIM) progression relative to peers. While overall NIMs may moderate QoQ due to lower spreads on overseas lending against these deposits, we see an attractive risk-reward profile as cyclical headwinds subside and we project a strong rebound in core pre-provision operating profit to an 18% CAGR from FY27E to FY29E. We maintain our 12m TP of Rs1,477. *Sumeet Kariwala*

Themes in Play | AmorePacific, ACMR

Amorepacific – Brand diversification supports overseas growth – Buy. We expect 3Q26 earnings to remain broadly in-line with guidance at 10% yoy revenue growth and a 10% operating margin. We view domestic channel resilience and broadening overseas momentum from Aestura, Innisfree, and COSRX as key drivers helping to offset softer Laneige sales and FX headwinds in Western markets. To reflect stronger domestic sales trends, we fine-tune our 2026E/2027E/2028E operating profit estimates by +2%/-3%/-4%, keeping our focus on the conversion of overseas marketing investments into 4Q revenue and new brand expansions in Europe. 12m TP of W180,000. *Eric Cha*

ACM Research – Strong Growth Visibility and Product Expansion – Buy. We remain constructive on the stock, supported by a robust Rmb17.1bn backlog that is up 88% YoY, reflecting solid demand from domestic memory and advanced logic customers alongside continued equipment localization. Furthermore, ongoing product expansion from cleaning into plating, furnace, PECVD, and advanced packaging tools tailored for HBM and CoWoS should drive higher equipment value content per customer and support sustained revenue growth. We lower our 12m TP to US\$159 from US\$166, while keeping our 2026-28E earnings estimates unchanged. *Allen Chang*

Previews | India Consumer, Solar Industries, India Insurance

India Consumer – 2QFY27 FMCG & Paints Preview. We expect most FMCG companies to deliver an acceleration in revenue growth in 2QFY27. The first driver is higher pricing growth in the quarter, as companies raised prices through 1QFY27 and the full impact of those price increases will flow through in 2QFY27. The second is an improvement in volume growth at some companies (for example, HUL, GCPL) which have a low base in FY26 caused by de-stocking due to the GST rate cuts announced by the government. We expect companies that do not have a low-base effect (for example, TCPL) to sustain the volume growth seen in 1QFY27 despite price increases. We expect the full impact of the increased raw material costs to flow through in 2QFY27 for most companies. While companies have implemented price increases, we expect a modest drop in EBITDA margins for most companies; hence, EBITDA growth will likely lag revenue growth. Buy TCPL (on CL), HUL, GCPL, Marico, Varun Beverages. *Arnab Mitra*

Solar Industries – Strong Q2FY27 expected driven by Defense and International – Buy.



We expect strong Q2FY27 results with revenue and EBITDA growing 49.8% and 54.7% YoY, respectively, driven by robust execution of international defense orders and mining traction. We project Defense revenue to surge 87.7% YoY to INR 9.5bn and expect EBITDA margins to expand 90bps YoY to 27.4%, though slightly down sequentially as the benefit of higher ammonium nitrate prices wanes. We see upside risks to consensus FY27 estimates given strong H1 revenue growth tracking ahead of management guidance. 12m TP of INR 26,550. *Amit Dixit*

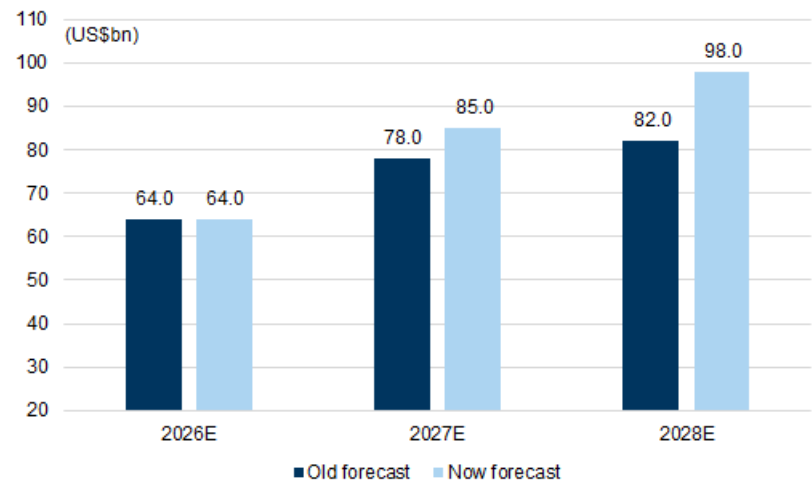
India Life Insurance – Q2FY27 preview: Focus on impact of potential distribution changes. Heading into Q2 earnings, we adjust estimates across our coverage, revising FY27E-29E value of new business by -3% to +1% and lowering EPS by up to 4%, which drives price target reductions of 3% to 8%. While topline growth remains steady, we expect investors to focus on management commentary regarding the impact of proposed IRDA distribution changes, subdued ULIP demand given volatile markets, and margin developments as GST headwinds ease. We anticipate idiosyncratic margin trends, with IPRU and LIC seeing healthy expansion on better product mix, while HDFC Life and SBI Life cycle through GST impacts. We remain Buy rated on HDFC Life and SBI Life, as we believe long-term growth drivers remain intact at reasonable valuations. *Shyam Srinivasan*

Around the world | SpaceX, US Semis

Space Exploration Technologies Corp. – Raising AI Revenue Estimates on Strong Compute Monetization – Buy. Ahead of Q3 results, we raise our 12m TP to \$230 from \$220 and materially increase our AI segment revenue forecasts to \$27.3bn in FY26, \$90.4bn in FY27, and \$146.7bn in FY28. These upward revisions are driven by heightened visibility into terrestrial compute scaling, which we expect to reach 2.4GW by year-end 2026, and strong monetization rates of \$20bn to \$50bn per GW from recent infrastructure hosting deals. We believe Street consensus for the AI segment remains overly conservative over the next 12 to 18 months, while Starship's continued technical progress toward rapid reusability provides a structural unlock for orbital compute and future connectivity capacity. *Eric Sheridan*

US Semiconductors – 3Q Preview: Expect stocks to work on better numbers following sector-wide pullback. We see a constructive trading setup across most semiconductor sub-sectors heading into 3Q earnings following a recent de-risking pullback, expecting significant positive estimate revisions for SemiCap companies alongside compute upside driven by agentic AI. We favor analog names with industrial and datacenter exposure as well as HDD and NAND memory providers, spotlighting tactical upside for Applied Materials, Cadence, Microchip, and Seagate, while seeing near-term downside risks for Arm Holdings, KLA, Qualcomm, and Western Digital. Reflecting stronger server CPU demand and higher margins, we raise our EPS estimates for AMD by roughly 6% and increase our 12m TP to \$700. *James Schneider*

Graphic language | TSMC (Buy) capex forecast revisions



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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